The Audiences

I seek to reach several different audiences through this book. The first and most important readership is the average Indian, particularly Indian youth. The hunger among a rising generation of Indians for knowledge and perspectives about India's place in the world is immense. One need only interact with university audiences or civil service aspirants in a given Indian city. I hope that students in college classrooms; lifelong students in bookstores, cafes and living rooms; and civil service and military trainees in places like Mussoorie and Mhow derive the most out of it.

I also, in part, wrote this for those new to India, whether foreign diplomats, journalists, or businesspeople, or simply those living abroad, with a particular interest in the country. This should provide an accessible introduction to at least one important element of India's complexity. Visitors' first impressions of India do not always consider the historical background—in some cases, how far India has travelled or the occasionally unprecedented nature of new developments. In other cases, they may be unfamiliar with important historical or cultural contexts, or past precedents for contemporary Indian actions or policies.

While it is not its primary purpose, the book can also serve as a rough guide for Indian policymakers. In an era of more fractious political rhetoric and social media polarization, it tries to offer a plain and concise road map for India's international dealings. This is an attempt to connect the dots and make evident the contours of India's policies and strategies. Part II: Strategy, in particular, is meant to give a sense of broad objectives and priorities that can help guide contemporary policymakers.

Finally, while not strictly an academic volume, it does engage with contemporary academic debates about India in international relations. The book has benefited from considerable scholarship done by others, particularly historians and diplomatic practitioners, and can hopefully serve as an introductory text in classrooms. The numerous citations, multiple references, and catalogue for further reading can also possibly serve as a